What Cowork Has to Offer

A short overview, October 2026

What it is

Cowork brings Claude's agentic abilities to the Claude desktop app for everyday knowledge work, not just coding. You describe an outcome, and Claude plans the steps, works through them, and hands back finished results, with no terminal needed.

Work with your own files

Claude can read and write files in folders you choose to share, such as organising a messy folder, merging spreadsheets, or drafting documents from your notes. Folder-specific instructions give it lasting project context.

Professional outputs

It produces real deliverables: Excel workbooks with formulas, PowerPoint decks, Word documents, PDFs, and formatted reports.

Long-running, multi-step tasks

Cowork can coordinate sub-agents on parallel workstreams and keep going on larger jobs that would time out in a normal chat. You can check in or step away while it works.

Plugins, skills and connectors

Pre-built plugins cover areas like productivity, sales, finance, legal and marketing, and can be customised or uploaded. Skills package repeatable procedures, and connectors link Claude to tools such as Slack, Drive or project trackers.

Browser and scheduling

Claude can browse the web and fill in forms on your behalf, and scheduled tasks let routine work run automatically on a timetable.

Safety and control

Cowork runs in an isolated virtual machine and only sees what you share. It asks permission before deleting files.

Availability and limits

Research preview on paid plans (Pro, Max, Team, Enterprise) in Claude Desktop for macOS and Windows. The app must stay open during tasks, and there is no cross-session memory or session sharing. Anthropic advises against using it for regulated workloads.

Source: Anthropic, "Getting started with Cowork" (support.claude.com). Features may change as the preview evolves.